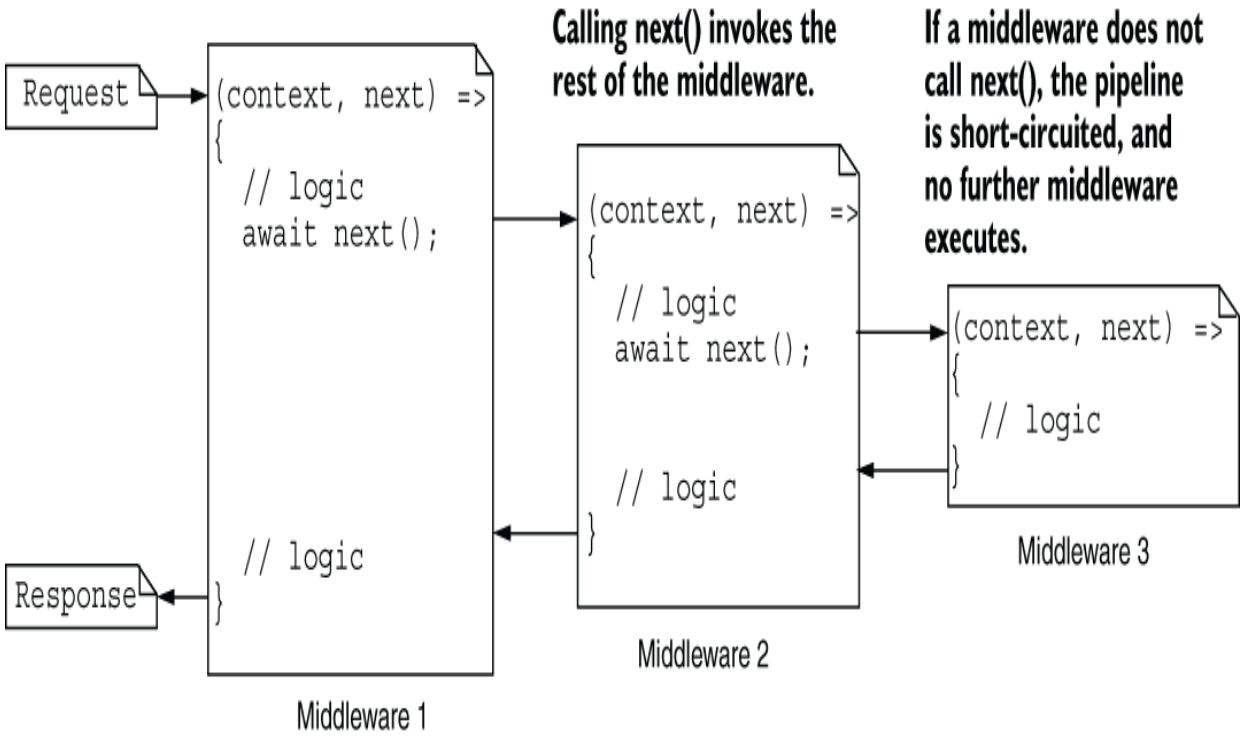


Figure 31.3 Three pieces of middleware, created with the `Use` extension. Invoking the provided `Func<Task>` using `next()` invokes the rest of the pipeline. Each middleware component can run code before and after calling the rest of the pipeline, or it can choose to not call `next()` to short-circuit the pipeline.

Exposing the rest of the pipeline as a `Func<Task>` makes it easy to conditionally short-circuit the pipeline, which enables many scenarios. Instead of branching the pipeline to implement the health-check middleware with `Map` and `Run`, as you did in listing 31.2, you could use a single instance of the `Use` extension, as shown in the following listing. This provides the same required functionality as before but does so without branching the pipeline.

Listing 31.3 Using the `Use` extension method to create a health-check middleware